dor — Room UI and UX Spec

Oct 24, 2026 · @Rishi

Overview

dor helps people build a support network during a life transition: starting college, moving to a new city, starting a job or graduating. Meeting new people and finding real things to do nearby is the main path; keeping up with the people you left behind is a supporting path. This spec follows the README's D045 direction exactly.

The whole app is one room. You walk in through a door, and from then on every "page" is the camera moving to a different part of that same room: zooming into the window to see events, into the windowsill to meet people, into the desk to write, and back out to the whole room.

The product, in the README's words

> Choose a new chapter → discover people and real things to do → make the first human connection.

Core journey (new connections): choose a transition and broad area → separately opt in to selected profile fields → see eligible public profiles and source-backed activities → choose a reason to connect → send an in-app introduction → recipient accepts or declines → optionally agree on a shared activity.

Supporting journey (existing ties): optional private reflection in the notebook, then nudges to people you're already paired with. Each nudge is previewed and approved by default; automatic sending only happens for one named person under a standing rule you set up yourself (D044, off by default).

Where each part of the product lives

Part of the product	Where it lives in the room
Sign in, unlock, choose your new chapter	**The door**
First-time setup: area, quiz, people from home	**Moving boxes** in the corner

Part of the product	Where it lives in the room
Your public profile (selected fields you publish)	**The pinboard** above the desk
Real local events (Apify feed)	**The window**: flyers outside
Nearby people with public profiles	**Postcards on the windowsill**
Introductions you receive	**Envelopes slid under the door** onto the mat
People you're connected to, new and old	**The shelf**: loose pages and books
Plans you've both agreed to	**The desk calendar**
Optional private journal (voice or typed)	**The notebook** on the desk
Nudges about existing ties	**Paper planes** in the desk tray; outgoing previews as **envelopes with a stamp**
Privacy and controls	**The desk drawer**

Demo cast

Maya just moved to Berkeley for college. New: Priya, a nearby student who also pinned climbing, and a Saturday climbing meetup from the events feed. From home: Leo (partner, long distance), Mom, Sam (high-school friend).

Rules every screen follows

1. **One room, one camera.** After the door there are no page changes. Every navigation is a camera move inside the same room, and "back" always means zooming out.
2. **Phone-first, portrait.** Designed at 390 × 844. Desktop shows the same phone layout centred on paper.
3. **The journal never gates discovery.** Everything on the window, sill, mat, pinboard and calendar works with the notebook locked or never used.
4. **Every consent is a separate, visible act.** Publishing your pinboard, showing interest in an event, sending an introduction, accepting one, agreeing to a plan, and approving a nudge are each their own gesture. None of them is implied by another, and none is granted by the quiz, a preset, a journal entry or the AI.

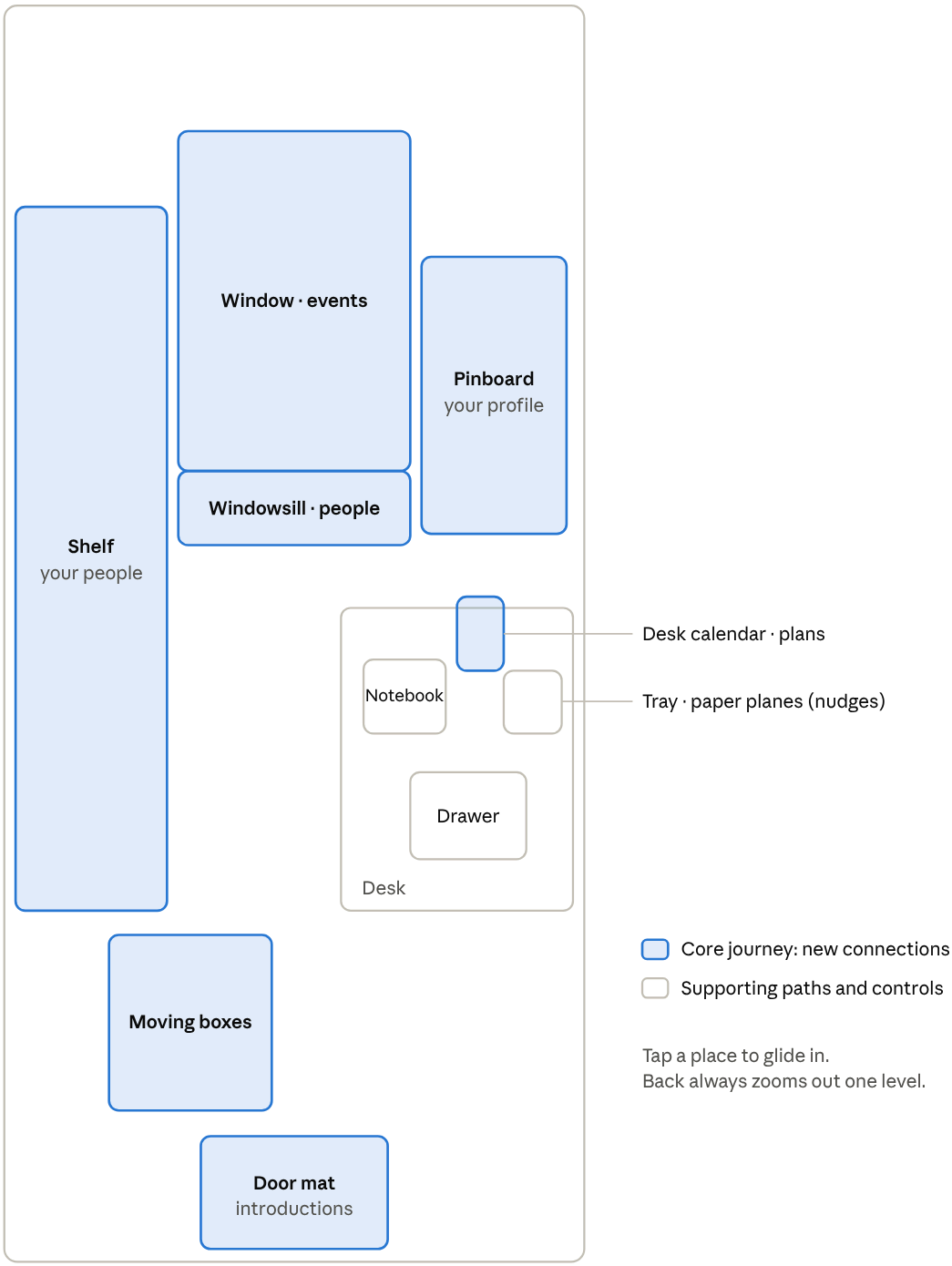
5. **Claude helps, it never acts as you.** It can suggest a pin, a reason or a gentle next step. It never decides who is eligible, never writes a message sent as you, and never sends anything.
6. **Honest states.** Event cards show where they came from and how fresh they are; sample data is labelled; "nothing nearby yet" is a real answer, not a spinner.
7. **Colour follows real connection, and never fades.** People you've actually met gain their watercolor wash; colour is never taken away and never tied to how much you use the app.

The room and the camera

The room is one tall painted image the same shape as a phone screen, so the "home" shot shows the whole room at once. Every place is a rectangle inside that image, and the camera glides to it.

Every place is one camera move away in the same room

Home shot of the room. The door is behind you, so the mat sits at the bottom edge.



room map · home shot, 11 places

The new-connection places (highlighted) sit where the eye lands first: the window and sill at the centre, the mat at the bottom edge, the pinboard beside them.

Layout of the room (home shot)

Positions are fractions of the room image, from the top left (u across, v down). Engineers place hotspots with these; artists compose the room so each object sits inside its box.

Place	Where in the room	Box (u, v → u, v)
Window, with the city outside	Back wall, centre, upper half	0.30, 0.10 → 0.70, 0.37
Windowsill postcards	Ledge under the window	0.30, 0.37 → 0.70, 0.43
Shelf	Left wall, floor to near ceiling	0.02, 0.16 → 0.28, 0.72
Pinboard	Right wall, above the desk	0.72, 0.20 → 0.97, 0.42
Desk	Right side, middle	0.58, 0.48 → 0.98, 0.72
Notebook	On the desk, left	0.62, 0.52 → 0.76, 0.58
Desk calendar	On the desk, back	0.78, 0.47 → 0.86, 0.53
Tray for paper planes	On the desk, right	0.86, 0.53 → 0.96, 0.58
Drawer	Front of the desk	0.70, 0.61 → 0.90, 0.68
Moving boxes	Floor, centre left (gone after setup)	0.18, 0.74 → 0.46, 0.88
Door mat	Bottom edge, centre: the door is behind you	0.34, 0.90 → 0.66, 0.99

Three zoom levels

Level	What you see	Example
Room	The whole room	Home
Place	One area fills the screen	The window, the shelf, the desk
Close-up	One object, with its controls on paper beside it	A single postcard, the open notebook, one book

How you move

- **Tap a place** to glide to it. The camera fits the place's box to the screen with a 16 px margin (`expo`, 1.0 s from room to place; 0.5 s from place to close-up).
- **Back** always zooms out one level: the ink arrow at top left, a swipe down, a pinch out, or the phone's back gesture. Each zoom adds a browser history entry, so the system back button works too.
- **Moving between neighbours** (window to sill, desk to pinboard) is a short arc: the camera eases out about 20%, slides across and eases back in, so you never lose your sense of where you are.
- **Double-tap a bare wall** to go straight back to the whole room.
- **Old routes become camera targets**, so links and notifications still work: `/onboarding` → boxes, `/discover` → sill, `/events` → window, `/connections` → shelf, `/journal` → notebook, `/nudges` → tray, `/privacy` → drawer.

Signals in the room instead of badges

There are no red dots. Something new shows up as a physical change you can spot from the whole-room view: a new postcard leaning on the sill, an envelope on the mat, a paper plane in the tray, a fresh flyer outside the window. On a first visit, each tappable place glows softly once, in sequence, then never again.

Rules that keep it usable

- **Tap targets.** At room level objects are small, so every place has an invisible tap area of at least 44 × 44 px around it.
- **Text is never painted into the art.** Names, dates, buttons and event details are live text laid over the image, so they stay sharp at any zoom and work with screen readers.

- **Controls sit on paper beside the object** at close-up level, not in pop-up dialogs.
- **A list view for everyone.** The drawer has "Show as a list", which lays every place out as a plain, accessible list for screen readers or anyone who prefers it.
- **Reduced motion.** Every glide becomes a 300 ms crossfade to the same framing.

Colour scheme

The palette is paper and ink with soft, colourful pastel watercolors: blues, pinks, yellows, oranges, lavender and mint. Nothing is bright or saturated; every wash looks like it was mixed with plenty of water. One rule gives colour meaning: **sky blue means "this goes to another person."** Every relationship gets its own pastel wash, and pencil grey means "only you can see this." The app stays light-only.

Base: paper and ink

Token	Hex	Used for
`--paper`	`#FAF7F0`	App background, walls, notebook pages
`--paper-deep`	`#EFE8CF`	Floor boards, desk top, the band behind the phone on desktop
`--card-stock`	`#FBF4E4`	Paper planes, notes, flyers, slips
`--wash-grey`	`#F1ECE0`	Quiet surfaces: drawer interior, disabled buttons
`--rule`	`#E4DFD2`	Ruled notebook lines, dividers, shelf edges
`--ink`	`#1B1A17`	All body text and the ink line art (warm black, never pure #000)
`--pencil-line`	`#A39E93`	Pencil sketch lines for unpainted objects (art only, too light for text)
`--pencil-text`	`#6B665D`	Owner-only text: reflections, pause tags, "Only you can see this" (5.3:1 on paper)

Meaning: what goes out, what's suggested, what's wrong

Token	Hex	Used for
`--sky`	`#9DBEE8`	The "goes to another person" wash: pinned cards, paper planes, the nudge note's top strip, the sent log. Never used for decoration.
`--sky-ink`	`#2F5C91`	Text and lines on or beside sky elements (6.4:1 on paper)
`--sky-wash`	`#EAF2FC`	Background of pin cards and the unfolded nudge note
`--sky-pale`	`#C9DCF3`	A suggested pin before you pin it; a plane's faint trail out the window
`--mint`	`#A8DCC4`	New-connection accents: introduction flyers, loose pages for people you just met
`--amber`	`#8A5A00`	Problems to fix: microphone off, offline, provider unavailable. A darker tone than the pastels so it reads as a warning.

Relationship washes (book spines and paint-in)

Each relationship type has a pastel watercolor wash for its book and nudges, plus a darker shade for any text beside it.

Relationship	Pastel wash	Text shade
Partner	`#F2A7B8` pink	`#A3455D`
Friend	`#F6D77A` butter yellow	`#7E6210`
Family	`#F7B98B` peach orange	`#9A5524`
Other	`#C3B1E1` lavender	`#5E4B85`

Washes are painted at 70–90% opacity with slightly darker pooled edges and soft blooms, so the paper texture shows through without the colour going muddy. A book with no paint yet is drawn in `--pencil-line` only.

Rules for using colour

- **One accent per moment.** A screen shows at most one relationship wash plus sky blue. A nudge about Leo uses pink (his book) and sky (the note), nothing else.
- **Sky is reserved.** If something is sky blue, it goes to another person or already has. Links, hovers and navigation use ink.
- **Pencil is private.** Pause tags, reflections, loose-page names and "Only you can see this" are pencil.
- **Text contrast.** Body text is ink on paper (16:1). Pastel washes are never text colours; use the text shade column.

Typography and motion

Type tells you who wrote something: your hand in ink, a private suggestion in pencil, and anything that crosses to another person in typewriter. Motion reuses PIXX-AR's exact curves and timings so the whole app moves like one piece.

Typefaces (all Google Fonts)

Role	Face	Size / line height	Where
Your hand (ink)	Caveat 500	26 / 34 px	Transcribed journal words, names on book spines, envelope address
Pencil hand	Reenie Beanie 400	24 / 30 px	Clarification margin notes, pause labels, "Only you can see this"
Body and UI	Newsreader 400, 500 italic	17 / 26 px body, 15 / 22 px small	Buttons, settings, edit mode of the journal, drawer lists
Typed card (goes out)	Courier Prime 400	16 / 24 px	Pinned cards, the nudge note text, event flyers

Scale for Newsreader: 13, 15, 17, 22, 28 px. Labels in small caps get 0.06em letter-spacing. When the user taps a journal line to edit, it switches from Caveat to Newsreader so editing is precise; tapping Done fades it back to handwriting over 300 ms.

Easing curves (copy from PIXX-AR `landing/motion.ts`)

Register these once with GSAP's CustomEase and use only these names everywhere.

Name	Cubic bezier	Use
`out`	0.23, 1, 0.32, 1	Default for anything arriving: cards, notes, words
`expo`	0.16, 1, 0.3, 1	Camera pushes and pans, door swing
`slide`	0.55, 0, 0.1, 1	Sheets and drawers moving in both directions, book sliding off shelf
`pop`	0.19, 1.51, 0.29, 0.99	The plane landing, a pin pressing in, small confirmations (slight overshoot)
`exit`	0.71, 0.01, 0.81, -0.51	Things leaving: a plane flying out the window, a flyer you passed on
`shake`	0.36, 0.07, 0.19, 0.97	A pin tapping into the cork, mic-denied wobble

Durations

Token	Seconds	Use
`fast`	0.3	Taps, toggles, fades, word reveal per word
`base`	0.5	Cards, notes, book tilt
`slow`	1.0	Plane flight steps, paint-in bloom
`page`	1.2	Camera push from room into notebook or book
`truck`	1.6	Door entry, plane flights

Performance rules (how we stay as smooth as PIXX-AR)

1. **Animate only `transform` and `opacity`.** Paint-in uses `clip-path` on one small element at a time, never on full-screen layers.
2. **One animation loop.** GSAP's ticker drives everything, including idle parallax. No `setInterval`, no competing CSS animations on the same element.
3. **Pre-rendered art.** Every painted view and object is an exported image (AVIF, WebP fallback). No live SVG filters, blurs or watercolor effects at runtime.

4. **Promote moving layers.** Set `will-change: transform` on a layer only while it moves, then remove it so the browser re-sharpens it.
5. **Cap pixel density.** Cap rendering at a device pixel ratio of 2 on phones; the room is exported at 6× and close-ups at 3× (see Assets) so camera zooms stay sharp.
6. **Big moments are video.** The door opening and the paint-in bloom on the shelf can be short pre-rendered clips (H.264 MP4, muted, `playsinline`) crossfaded with the still, as PIXX-AR does with its "flyouts".
7. **Idle parallax.** Room layers drift with phone tilt or pointer position, damping 0.04 per frame, max 8 px travel, as PIXX-AR's manifest does. Off when the user prefers reduced motion.
8. **Reduced motion.** Every camera move becomes a 300 ms crossfade; the stamp, plane and paint-in become fades. The order of events stays the same.
9. **Preload the next view.** While on the desk, decode the notebook and window images (`img.decode()`) so the first push never stutters.

Journeys

Ten journeys cover the whole product. The first six are the README's core path for new connections; the rest support existing ties and control. Each step names the place in the room and the camera move.

1. First visit: choose a new chapter

1. **Door.** Sign in. A paper tag on the door asks "What's your new chapter?" with four choices: Starting college, New city, New job, Just graduated.
2. The door swings open and the camera pushes into a **bare room**: pencil lines only, three taped moving boxes on the floor.
3. **Box: "Where you've landed".** Asks for your location once. It's coarsened on the device to a broad area ("Berkeley · Southside") before anything is sent. No background tracking. Skip means you pick the area from a list instead.
4. **Box: "About you".** Six to eight skippable quiz slips about how you like to connect. Answers personalize suggestions and become *suggested* pin cards; they are never published.
5. **Box: "From home" (optional).** Add existing people. Their books go on the shelf. This box can stay taped for later.
6. Camera glides to the **pinboard**: "Want people nearby to see you?" (journey 2).

7. Whether or not you publish, the camera pulls back to the whole room. The window fills with the painted city and its first event flyers.

2. Publish your pinboard (public profile)

1. **Pinboard.** Suggested cards sit faded at the edge. Tap to pin the ones you want: first name, your chapter ("New to Berkeley"), interests, "open to" tags.
2. **Preview.** "This is exactly what eligible people near Berkeley will see," showing the card layout a stranger would get.
3. **Put it up.** A small wooden sign on the board flips from "Just for me" to "Visible nearby". That flip is the publication consent.
4. Edit any time. **Take it down** turns the sign back, and your postcard disappears from everyone's sill at once.

3. Find a real thing to do

1. **Window.** Flyers are pinned outside along the frame and a lamppost: real events from the configured Apify feed.
2. Tap a flyer to close up: title, day, time, broad area, where it came from ("from Luma") and how fresh it is ("checked 2 h ago").
3. **I'm interested** keeps a private note just for you; a small ribbon appears on the flyer.
4. **Show my interest to people nearby** is a separate tap with its own preview. Only then can the event appear as a shared reason on someone's postcard.
5. Nothing here reveals who else is going. Listings are never treated as attendance.

4. Meet someone new

1. **Windowsill.** A short row of postcards: nearby people whose profiles are public and who are eligible to see you too.
2. Tap one to close up. The front shows their first name and chapter. Flip it over to see their pinned fields and why it's here, in fixed reason labels: "You both pinned climbing", "You're both interested in Saturday's meetup".
3. **Send an introduction.** Pick a reason from a fixed list (grab coffee, study together, go to an event together), and optionally attach an event both of you can see.
4. **Preview.** Exactly what they'll see. Claude may suggest the reason but never writes a message.
5. **Send.** The postcard slides into a sky-blue envelope and flies out the window.

6. The sill shows a small pencil tag on that postcard: "Introduction sent". It changes to "Accepted" when they accept.

5. Receive an introduction

1. **Door mat.** An envelope slides in under the door with a soft paper sound, visible from the whole-room view.
2. Tap to open it: their postcard, the reason, and the attached event if any.
3. **Accept**, **Not now** or **Block**. Not now and Block are silent to the sender beyond the open question in the last section.
4. On accept, both rooms get a **loose page** on the shelf's "New here" side.

6. Agree on a plan, then meet

1. From a loose page or an accepted introduction, tap **Plan this**: pick an event or a time.
2. The plan is a small card with one revision. The other person sees the same card and must accept that exact revision. Any edit creates a new revision that both must accept again.
3. Accepted plans appear on the **desk calendar**, with a pastel dot in that person's colour.
4. After the plan's time, a gentle question appears on the calendar: "Did you meet up?" When both say yes, the loose page folds into a **book** and gets its first watercolor wash. The city outside the window gains one more lit window, and keeps it.

7. Keep up with someone from home (supporting)

1. **Notebook (optional).** Write or speak an entry. Voice goes through Cartesia, with a typed fallback.
2. Claude makes a private, owner-only assessment. If unsure, it asks at most two neutral questions as pencil notes in the margin. Skip means no action.
3. **Manual mode (default).** If a nudge makes sense, an envelope appears addressed to one person, with the exact recipient-facing template on a card inside. Hold the stamp to approve. Not now discards it.
4. **Automatic mode (only with a standing rule, journey 8).** The nudge goes without a preview and without a sender alert or receipt, as the README requires.
5. **The recipient** gets a paper plane in their desk tray with a fixed-template note and can act, dismiss or pause.

8. Set up a standing rule (D044)

1. Open a book from home on the **shelf**. Tap **Always okay to send**.
2. Choose allowlisted categories, an expiry, and the rule's purpose. The page states plainly that future matching nudges may go to this person without asking each time.
3. Tie on the ribbon to confirm. A small ribbon hangs from that book's spine while the rule is active.
4. Untie it (in the book or the drawer) to revoke immediately. Expired rules untie themselves.

9. Pause, block, withdraw

- **Pause someone from home:** long-press the book; it turns spine-in. Only you see that.
- **Block someone new:** from their postcard or loose page. They disappear from your room and you from theirs, with no notice to them.
- **Withdraw:** take down the pinboard, untick event interest, or recall an introduction that hasn't been answered yet. Each removes dependent cards everywhere.

10. Lock and leave

- **Lock the notebook** from its clasp or the drawer key. Only the journal locks; the window, sill, mat, pinboard and calendar keep working.
- **Sign out** at the drawer. The camera pulls back out through the door and it closes.

Every place in the room, part 1: arriving and meeting people

Each place below lists its look, how the camera arrives, what you can do there, and the ambitious details that make it feel alive.

The door

Replaces: sign-in and the new-chapter choice.

- **Look:** A hallway in soft pastel watercolor: a peach wall, a tall door in pale sky blue with ink linework, a brass knob, a doormat lettered "dor". A small brass name plate shows your first name once you're signed in.
- **First visit:** A paper tag hangs from the knob: "What's your new chapter?" with four ink-circled choices. Your pick is written on the tag in your hand (Caveat) and stays there.

- **Entering:** Tap the knob. The door swings inward in 3D (rotateY 0 → −78°, `expo`, 1.6 s) while the camera pushes through the doorway (scale 1 → 2.6). Light from the room spills into the hallway as the door opens. The room fades up from the light.
- **Signed out:** A card-stock tag reads "Sign in to come in" with the sign-in button under it.
- **Repeat visits:** A 0.6 s quick push. The full swing plays once a day, or on a long-press for demos.
- **Ambitious:** The hallway light matches your local time of day: cool morning light, golden afternoon, lamplit evening. A faint muffled sound of the room (rain, birds, city) plays as you approach the door, matching the weather outside the window.

Moving boxes

Replaces: `/onboarding`.

- **Look:** Three cardboard boxes with masking tape, labelled in marker: "Where you've landed", "About you", "From home". They're the only coloured things in a pencil-drawn room on day one.
- **Camera:** Glides to the floor and tilts slightly down, as if you're kneeling by the boxes.
- **Opening:** Tap a box; the tape peels (`out`, 0.3 s), the flaps open in 3D, and its contents rise out.
  - **Where you've landed:** A folded paper map rises out. One tap asks for location once; a pencil circle draws itself around your broad area. Or pick an area from a list.
  - **About you:** Paper slips rise out one at a time, each one quiz question with ink-circled answers. Swipe a slip away to answer or skip. Answers turn into suggested pin cards that float to the pinboard edge.
  - **From home:** Books rise out and fly to the shelf's "From home" side, each with a "waiting for them to accept" tag.
- **Finishing:** An opened box folds flat and slides under the desk. Unopened boxes stay in the corner as a gentle, non-blocking reminder.
- **Ambitious:** As boxes empty, the room starts to colour in: the floor gets its wash, then the walls. It's a quiet signal that you're moving in.

The pinboard (your public profile)

- **Look:** A cork board with a light wash, held up by two brass hooks. Cards are pastel paper held with coloured push pins. A small wooden sign hangs from one corner.
- **Camera:** Straight-on, filling the screen.

- **Cards you can pin:** First name, your chapter, interests (each its own card), "open to" tags (study buddy, climbing partner, coffee), and an optional short line in your words. Only the fields the C8 contract allows appear here.
- **Pinning:** Drag a faded suggestion onto the cork; it presses in with a small `pop` and a pin sound. Long-press a pinned card to edit or unpin.
- **The sign:** "Just for me" or "Visible nearby". Flipping it to visible opens the preview of exactly what others see; confirming flips the sign (3D flip, `pop`, 0.5 s). Flipping back unpublishes everywhere at once.
- **Claude:** may suggest a card after a notebook entry (faded, at the edge). It never pins or publishes anything.
- **Ambitious:** When your board is visible, a faint warm light falls across it from the window, as if it faces the street. When it's private, the board sits in soft shadow.

The window (events)

Replaces: `/events`.

- **Look:** A tall window with sheer curtains. Outside is a painted view of your area: rooftops, trees, a few streets. Paper flyers are pinned along the window frame and on a lamppost just outside.
- **Camera:** Glides to the window, then leans slightly forward, as if you're looking out.
- **Flyers:** Each one is a real event from the configured feed: title in Caveat, then day, time and broad area in Courier Prime. A small stamp in the corner shows the source and freshness ("Luma · checked 2 h ago"). Sample events carry a "sample" stamp.
- **Close-up:** Tap a flyer and it unpins and floats to the centre. Actions: **I'm interested** (private), **Show my interest nearby** (separate, with preview), **Open listing** (link out), **Not for me** (the flyer drifts away).
- **Matching:** A pencil note on the flyer explains why it's here, in fixed labels: "You pinned climbing", "Near Southside".
- **Ambitious:**
  - **Time and weather:** The sky follows local time (dawn, day, golden hour, night with lit windows) and the broad area's real weather: rain streaks on the glass, fog, snow.
  - **Flyers that move:** Flyers flutter gently in the wind; a new one pins itself on with a little flourish when the feed updates.
  - **The city lights up with your life:** Every connection you've actually met lights one window in the city, and it stays lit.

Windowsill postcards (nearby people)

Replaces: `/discover`.

- **Look:** A short row of postcards leaning against the window on the sill, each with a pastel stamp in the corner showing their chapter (a mortarboard, a suitcase, a briefcase).
- **Camera:** Glides down from the window to the sill.
- **Front of a postcard:** First name and chapter, with their pinboard colour as a wash behind the name. No photo by default.
- **Back (flip, 3D, 0.5 s):** Their pinned fields, the reason labels, and actions: **Send an introduction**, **Not for me** (it slides off the sill), **Block**.
- **Sending:** Choose a reason and optionally an event, see the exact preview, then send. The postcard slides into a sky-blue envelope that lifts off and flies out the window (`exit`, 0.6 s).
- **Shortlist:** At most five postcards at a time. More appear as people join or publish.
- **Ambitious:** Postcards you haven't looked at lean slightly forward; ones you've already introduced yourself to carry a small pencil tag and sit upright.

The door mat (introductions you receive)

- **Look:** The door is behind you, so the mat is at the bottom edge of the room view. Envelopes slide in under the door and land on it.
- **Arrival:** A soft knock sound, then the envelope slides in from the bottom edge and settles (`pop`). It's visible from the whole-room view.
- **Close-up:** The envelope opens and the sender's postcard slides out with their reason and any attached event. Actions: **Accept**, **Not now**, **Block**.
- **Accept:** The postcard flies to the shelf and becomes a loose page on the "New here" side, and the camera follows it there.
- **Ambitious:** The envelope's stamp shows the sender's chapter, and its paper is tinted by the reason (coffee, study, event).

Every place in the room, part 2: your people, your desk, your controls

The shelf (your people)

Replaces: `/connections`.

- **Look:** A tall wooden bookcase on the left wall. The middle shelf holds people: **New here** on the right, **From home** on the left. Top and bottom shelves hold non-book decoration (a plant, a frame, a candle) so nothing is mistaken for a person.
- **Camera:** Glides left and fills the screen with the bookcase.
- **Loose pages:** People you've accepted an introduction with but haven't met yet. A folded page leaning between books, first name and how you met in pencil ("Priya · climbing").
- **Books:** People you've actually met (new) or brought with you (from home). Name on the spine in Caveat. Books from home arrive with their pastel wash; new books get theirs when you first meet.
- **Spine details:** A ribbon means a standing rule is active (journey 8). Spine-in means paused (owner-only tag: "Leo · paused · 3 days"). A small pencil bookmark means it's been a while (owner-only, no guilt copy).
- **Close-up of a book:** It slides out 24 px, tilts toward you, flies to the centre and opens (`page`, 1.2 s). Left page: name, how you're connected, their pinned fields if public, your shared plans. Right page: controls (plan something, pause, standing rule, block or unlink).
- **Ambitious:** Books you've seen recently sit slightly forward on the shelf, and every book is a little different in height, thickness and tilt so the shelf looks lived-in.

The desk calendar (plans)

- **Look:** A small paper flip calendar on a stand at the back of the desk, showing this week.
- **Camera:** Glides to the desk and settles on the calendar.
- **Plans:** Each accepted plan is a pastel dot in that person's colour on its day. Tap a day to see the plan card: event or activity, time, broad area, and its revision.
- **Pending plans:** Shown as a pencil outline dot until both of you accept the same revision. A changed plan shows "Changed. Waiting for Priya to accept."
- **After the plan:** "Did you meet up?" appears on the day. Both saying yes turns the loose page into a book with its first wash.

- **Ambitious:** Flipping to next week is a real page flip (`slide` , 0.5 s) with a paper sound.

The notebook (optional private journal)

Replaces: `/journal` .

- **Look:** A cloth-covered notebook with a brass clasp. Inside: ruled pages, a pencil margin, today's date in Caveat.
- **Camera:** Glides to the desk, then pushes down to a top-down view; the cover swings open in 3D.
- **Writing:** A round ink mic button, "Hold to speak", with "or write instead" under it. A pencil line notes that voice goes to Cartesia to be transcribed. Words write themselves in Caveat as they arrive, revealed like a pen stroke (`fast` , staggered 40 ms).
- **Editing:** Tap a line to edit it in Newsreader; Done returns it to handwriting.
- **Reflection:** Claude's private notes, and at most two neutral questions, appear as pencil notes taped in the margin, each with Skip.
- **Lock:** The clasp locks only the notebook. Everything else in the room keeps working.
- **Ambitious:** The notebook gains pages and a slightly worn spine as you use it, and pressed flowers mark entries where you chose to do nothing.

Paper planes and envelopes (nudges about existing ties)

Replaces: `/nudges` and the sharing review.

- **Receiving:** A pastel paper plane flies in through the window and lands in the desk tray (`expo` then `pop` , 2.0 s). Tap it to unfold it in three steps into a note: a strip of the sender's colour and a fixed template ("Maybe check in with Maya this week"). Actions: **I reached out**, **Not now**, **Pause notes from Maya**.
- **Sending, manual (default):** After a notebook entry, an envelope may appear on the desk addressed to one person. A card inside shows the exact template they'd see. Hold the wooden stamp for 0.8 s to approve; a sky-blue postmark lands with a `pop` and the envelope flies out. Not now discards it.
- **Sending, automatic (standing rule):** No envelope, no alert, no receipt, as the README requires. The rule's ribbon on the book is the only sign it exists.
- **Ambitious:** The plane's flight path curves around objects in the room, and its shadow moves across the floor and desk as it flies.

The drawer (privacy and controls)

Replaces: `/privacy`.

- **Look:** The desk drawer slides toward you; inside are physical objects, one per control.
- **Camera:** Tilts down to the desk front; the drawer slides out (`slide`, 0.5 s) and the view looks down into it.
- **Objects:**
  - **Key:** lock or unlock the notebook.
  - **Wooden sign (small copy):** your pinboard visibility, with Take down.
  - **Ribbons:** every active standing rule, each with Untie (revoke).
  - **Pencil tags:** everyone paused, with time left and Resume.
  - **Folded list:** people you've blocked, with Unblock.
  - **Map scrap:** your broad area, with Change area.
  - **Ticket stubs:** events you've shown interest in, with Withdraw.
  - **Index card:** "Show as a list" for the accessible list view.
  - **Door key on a ring:** Sign out.
- **Ambitious:** Objects in the drawer jostle slightly when it opens, and the drawer sticks for a frame before sliding, like a real one.

The room over time

The room settles in as your new life does, tied only to real connections.

Moment	What changes
All boxes opened	Boxes fold flat under the desk; floor and walls get their wash
Pinboard first made visible	Light from the window falls across the board
First new person met	A rug appears on the floor; one window in the city lights up
Three new people met	A plant appears on the sill; curtains get a pattern
A plan with someone from home	The frame on the top shelf fills with colour

Nothing ever reverts, even in quiet weeks.

States

Every place has a designed answer for empty, loading, stale, failed and private situations. None of them is a spinner on a blank screen, and none hides that data is a sample.

Place	Situation	What you see
Window	Feed loading	Flyers already cached stay up; a pencil note: "Checking for new events…"
Window	Feed stale	Flyers stay, their stamp reads the real age ("checked 9 h ago")
Window	Feed unavailable	Last flyers stay with "couldn't check for new events"; if none, the window shows the quiet city and that line
Window	Sample data	Each flyer carries a "sample" stamp
Window	Nothing matches	Quiet city view: "No events nearby match right now. New ones appear as they're announced."
Sill	Board not visible	Pencil note: "Make your pinboard visible to see people nearby," with a button that glides to the pinboard
Sill	No one eligible	Empty sill: "No one nearby yet. People appear as they join and publish."
Sill	Someone withdrew or blocked	Their postcard simply isn't there; no message about why
Mat	Nothing received	Just the mat
Mat	Sender withdrew before you opened it	The envelope disappears; no note
Pinboard	Never published	Sign reads "Just for me"; suggested cards faded at the edge
Shelf	No one yet	The "From home" box stays taped in the corner with a pencil arrow; "New here" says "People you meet will show up here"

Place	Situation	What you see
Shelf	Invite not accepted	Book from home with a "waiting for them" tag
Calendar	Plan changed	Pencil dot: "Changed. Waiting for both of you to accept."
Calendar	Plan cancelled or event cancelled	The dot fades to pencil with "cancelled"
Notebook	Locked	Clasp closed; tapping it asks to unlock; nothing else in the room is affected
Notebook	Microphone off	Mic button wobbles once; amber line on how to turn it on; cursor moves to the page
Notebook	Voice or Claude unavailable	Amber line; typing still works; nothing is sent
Any	Offline	Amber line at the bottom: "Offline. Your notebook still works; anything you send will wait."
Any	Signed out mid-session	The camera pulls back to the door with the "Sign in to come in" tag

Privacy states are deliberately invisible to others: a pause, a block, a declined introduction or a suppressed nudge never produces a message, badge or change in timing on anyone else's side.

Components

The room is a shell that hosts the components each teammate already owns. Room components handle art, camera and motion; feature components keep their logic, data and guards and receive a paper skin. New room code lives in `src/components/room/`.

Room shell

Component	Job
`RoomStage`	The single world container: room layers, hotspots and overlays; owns the GSAP ticker
`CameraRig`	Camera targets from the layout table, glides, neighbour arcs, back stack, browser history, old-route mapping
`Hotspot`	Invisible 44 px+ button per place, with label for screen readers and the first-visit glow
`PlaceOverlay`	Paper sheet anchored beside an object at close-up level; hosts feature components
`SkyLayer`, `CityLights`	Window time-of-day, weather and lit windows for met connections
`RoomSettle`	Applies the "room over time" stages
`ListView`	Accessible plain-list version of every place
`motion.ts`, `sound.ts`	Named eases and durations; paper sounds with a mute toggle

Places and objects

Component	Place
`Door`, `ChapterTag`	Door
`MovingBox`	Moving boxes
`Pinboard`, `PinCard`, `VisibilitySign`	Pinboard
`Window`, `Flyer`, `SourceStamp`	Window
`Sill`, `Postcard`, `ReasonPicker`	Windowsill
`DoorMat`, `IntroEnvelope`	Door mat
`Shelf`, `Book`, `LoosePage`, `OpenBook`, `StandingRuleRibbon`	Shelf

Component	Place
`DeskCalendar`, `PlanCard`	Calendar
`Notebook`, `InkWords`, `MarginNote`	Notebook
`PaperPlane`, `NudgeEnvelope`, `Stamp`	Nudges
`Drawer`	Drawer
`PaintBloom`	Watercolor wash reveal on books, floor and walls; never reverses

Existing components hosted inside the room

Existing component (owner)	Hosted by
`discovery-area`, `discovery-profile`	`MovingBox` (area) and `Pinboard` (profile)
`discovery-results`, `introduction-suggestions`, `introduction-controls`	`Sill`, `Postcard`, `DoorMat`
`event-results`, `event-card`, `event-privacy`	`Window`, `Flyer`
`plans-list`	`DeskCalendar`
`quiz-fields`, onboarding quiz	`MovingBox` ("About you")
`PairsList`, `AccountInvites`	`Shelf`, `MovingBox` ("From home")
`VoiceReflection`, `SavedJournals` (AI)	`Notebook`
`DecisionLoop`	`MarginNote`
`ShareReview`	`NudgeEnvelope` and `Stamp` (manual mode)
D044 standing-rule settings (in progress)	`StandingRuleRibbon`
`ApprovedSignals`, `RecipientSettings`	`OpenBook`, `Drawer`
`PauseControls`, `ActivePauses`	`Book` (spine-in), `Drawer`
`VaultControls` (Cyber)	Notebook clasp, drawer key

The room never re-implements eligibility, consent or delivery. It passes the same props and calls the same reducers; only presentation changes.

Assets folder

Everything goes in `public/assets/`. Generate the master room first, then make every other image from it as image-to-image edits so paper, light and colour match. Make the pencil version of the room from the painted one so the two line up pixel for pixel for the colour-in reveals.

Prompts

Master room (generate first):

```
Portrait 9:16 watercolor illustration of a cozy student room, thin ink lines
on textured cold-press paper, soft pastel washes in sky blue, pink, butter
yellow and peach. Bookcase left, desk with notebook under a corkboard right,
big window with city. No people, no text.
```

Door and hallway:

```
Portrait 9:16 watercolor illustration of a hallway with one tall pale-blue
door, brass knob and doormat, thin ink lines on textured cold-press paper,
soft pastel peach walls, morning light. Airy and calm. No people, no text.
```

Export specs

- **Room:** 2340 × 5064 px (6× the 390 × 844 layout) so close-up zooms stay sharp, split into depth layers. AVIF at about quality 60 with a WebP fallback.
- **Close-ups:** 1170 × 2532 px each, crossfaded in when the camera arrives at close-up level.
- **Objects:** transparent WebP at 3× their on-screen size.
- **Sounds:** AAC `.m4a`, mono, under 60 KB. **Video:** H.264 MP4, muted, under 2 MB.

```
public/assets/
  room/       R_  the master room, split into depth layers
  closeups/   C_  high-res crops for close-up level
  sky/        K_  window sky by time of day and weather
  objects/    O_  things that move or are tapped
  paper/      P_  postcards, flyers, envelopes, planes, pins, tags
  books/      B_  spines, masks, open spreads
  textures/   T_  paper grain, cork, tape
  icons/      I_  hand-drawn ink icons (SVG)
  video/      M_  pre-rendered big moments
  audio/      S_  sounds
```

room/ and closeups/

File	Contents
`R_back.avif`	Back wall, window frame (glass area transparent), ceiling
`R_furniture.avif`	Shelf (empty middle shelf), desk, drawer front, lamp, pinboard frame
`R_floor.avif`	Floor and the bottom edge with the door mat
`R_*_line.avif`	Pencil-only versions of the three layers, for day one
`R_hallway.avif`, `O_door_panel.webp`	Door scene; the panel swings separately
`C_window.avif`, `C_sill.avif`, `C_shelf.avif`, `C_pinboard.avif`, `C_desk.avif`, `C_notebook_spread.avif`, `C_calendar.avif`, `C_drawer.avif`, `C_mat.avif`, `C_boxes.avif`	One close-up per place, framed exactly to the layout boxes

sky/

- `K_dawn`, `K_day`, `K_golden`, `K_night` city views, each with a transparent glass layer
- `K_rain`, `K_fog`, `K_snow` overlays

- `K_city_lights.webp`: a sheet of individual window lights the app switches on one by one

objects/, paper/, books/

File	Notes
`O_box_*.webp` (closed, open, flat)	Three boxes with marker labels
`O_map.webp`, `O_slip.webp`	Box contents
`O_notebook_closed.webp`, `O_notebook_cover.webp`, `O_clasp.webp`	Notebook and its 3D cover
`O_calendar.webp`, `O_tray.webp`, `O_stamp.webp`	Desk pieces
`O_drawer_*.webp`	Key, sign, ribbons, tags, list, map scrap, stubs, index card, door key
`O_rug.webp`, `O_plant.webp`, `O_curtain_pattern.webp`, `O_frame_line.webp`, `O_frame_wash.webp`	Settling-in pieces
`P_postcard_front.webp`, `P_postcard_back.webp`, `P_stamp_*.webp`	Postcards and chapter stamps
`P_flyer_*.webp` (3 shapes)	Event flyers with curled corners
`P_envelope_*.webp` (closed, open, flap)	Introductions and nudge envelopes
`P_plane.webp`, `P_unfold_1-3.webp`, `P_note.webp`	Nudge planes
`P_pin_card.webp`, `P_pushpin_*.webp`, `P_sign_front.webp`, `P_sign_back.webp`	Pinboard pieces
`B_spine_line_a-c.webp`, `B_wash_mask_a-c.webp`	Pencil spines and wash masks (colour applied in CSS)
`B_spine_back.webp`, `B_ribbon.webp`, `B_bookmark.webp`, `B_loose_page.webp`, `B_open_spread.webp`	Book states

textures/, icons/, video/, audio/

- **Textures:** `T_paper.avif` (tileable), `T_grain.webp`, `T_cork.avif`, `T_tape.webp`
- **Icons:** `I_mic`, `I_speaker`, `I_back`, `I_close`, `I_plus`, `I_lock`, `I_list` as single-stroke ink SVGs
- **Video:** `M_door_open.mp4` (door swing and push-through), `M_room_colours.mp4` (the room's first wash after setup)
- **Audio:** door, knock, envelope slide, paper flip, page turn, pen, pin, stamp, plane in, plane out, unfold, drawer, clasp, plus room tone loops for clear, rain and night. Sound is off until the user turns it on.

Fonts load from Google Fonts; no font files needed.

Build plan

The full vision, built in six layers. Each layer leaves the app working end to end, so there is always something to show, and each later layer makes the room richer without changing what came before.

Layer 1: the stage

1. `motion.ts` with the named eases and durations, and `sound.ts` with mute.
2. `RoomStage` and `CameraRig`: the layered room, the layout table as camera targets, glides, neighbour arcs, back stack, history and old-route mapping.
3. `Hotspot` and `PlaceOverlay`, plus `ListView` from day one so accessibility is never retrofitted.
4. The door with its 3D swing and push-through, and the chapter tag.
5. Art pipeline: master room, pencil version, depth layers, close-ups, all wired with placeholders replaced as they land.

Layer 2: the core journey

1. Moving boxes: area, quiz, from home.
2. Pinboard with suggested cards, the visibility sign and the publication preview.
3. Window with flyers from the Apify cache, source stamps, interest and shared interest.
4. Windowsill postcards with flip, reasons, introduction preview and the envelope flight.
5. Door mat with incoming envelopes, accept, not now and block.
6. Shelf with loose pages; desk calendar with plan revisions and "Did you meet up?".

Layer 3: existing ties

1. Books from home, open-book spreads, pause and block.
2. Notebook with voice, ink words, editing, margin notes and the clasp.
3. Nudge envelopes with the hold-to-stamp approval; paper planes in the tray.
4. Standing-rule ribbons and their revoke flow.
5. The drawer with every control object.

Layer 4: a living room

1. `SkyLayer`: time of day from the device clock and weather for the broad area.
2. `CityLights`: one lit window per person you've actually met.
3. `RoomSettle`: boxes folding away, floor and wall washes, rug, plant, curtains, frame.
4. Room tone that follows the weather and time, plus every paper sound.

Layer 5: craft

1. `PaintBloom` on every "first met" moment and on the room's first wash.
2. Plane flights that curve around furniture, with moving shadows.
3. Pre-rendered door and first-wash videos crossfaded with the stills.
4. Gyroscope and pointer parallax across the depth layers.
5. Light haptics on phones for the stamp, pins and envelope arrivals, where supported.
6. Page-curl for the notebook and calendar.

Layer 6: quality bar

- **Smoothness:** 60 fps for every glide on a mid-range phone; no dropped frames on the door swing.
- **Load:** the door and hallway on screen in under 2 s on 4G; room layers stream in behind the door animation; close-ups load as the camera heads toward them.
- **Weight:** under about 8 MB of art for a full session, lazily loaded.
- **Accessibility:** every hotspot labelled, the list view complete, reduced-motion crossfades everywhere, text contrast as in the colour section.
- **Privacy review:** every recipient-visible surface checked against the README's indirect-disclosure rules with Cyber.

Who builds what

Owner	Room work
CS (Rishi)	Stage, camera, door, art pipeline, window and Apify flyers, composition of every place
DS (Nimisha)	Postcard and flyer content, reason labels, no-fit states, ranking inside sill and window
AI (Adam)	Notebook, voice, margin notes, Claude suggestions for pins and reasons
Cyber (Sumedh)	Visibility sign, introduction and plan consent, block and withdraw, drawer controls, standing-rule ribbon

Open questions

These need a team decision; the spec uses the stated default until then.

- **Pinboard fields:** which exact fields does the C8 contract allow? Default: first name, chapter, interests, "open to" tags, one short line. No photo.
- **What a sender sees after "Not now":** default is the pencil tag on their postcard staying "Introduction sent" until it expires, with no decline shown.
- **"Did you meet up?":** does it need both people to confirm before a loose page becomes a book? Default: yes, both.
- **Weather in the window:** needs a weather source queried only with the broad area, server-side. Default: on, with time of day from the device clock; drop weather if the source can't meet that rule.
- **Postcard shortlist size:** default five at a time.
- **Standing-rule categories:** which nudge categories can a D044 rule cover? The ribbon UI shows whatever the contract allows.
- **Event source:** Luma or Meetup changes the stamp text on flyers ("from Luma").
- **Sound default:** off until the user turns it on, or on with a visible mute? Default: off.